

Be Interactive

It's one thing to watch, it's another to do it. They say if you want to boil your passions, test drive the car of your dreams. Interactivity increases response for anything. If you can taste it, feel it, or use it, you will be more likely to buy it.

Interaction is like hearing your name. It's your favorite. On Facebook, the most popular applications are "surveys" and "questionnaires" because people love narcissism. My favorite movie is *The Usual Suspects*! I love pizza! I own a poodle! People love to talk about themselves, and if you entwine that into your marketing plan, you will improve the response to your product or service.

For example, if I launch a survey "Are you speeding the Fastlane or stuck in the Slowlane? Find out now." I am engaging in an interactive campaign designed to get people involved and to talk about themselves. When your potential customers break down their personal barriers and expose pieces of themselves, they move closer to you as if there were a relationship. A relationship sells more than an anonymous corporate entity.

"Find out what happens next . . ." Some corporations are using traditional media and the Internet to foster interaction. I recently saw a commercial for an automobile manufacturer that filmed a story with a high-speed chase, except the story never concludes and we are left with "Find out what happens next . . . visit [Web site]." By teasing audiences with messages or stories that are incomplete, potential customers are forced to complete the story by visiting a Web site, and Web sites foster interaction.

The revolution of social media, blogs, and "Web 2.0" is founded on interaction. You just don't want to read an article; you want to comment on it! Your two cents must be heard!

Be Unconventional

Convention breeds familiarity. If you've seen it three dozen times in the last month, or something like it, do you think it will work? For example, "Be your own boss" is such an overused phrase its power has been drained. Yet, I still see advertising headlines and subtitles from so-called gurus using "Be your own boss," as if the phrase wielded power. Its been pulverized into flaccidity, so why the heck are you using it?

What's unconventional? Have you ever seen a Lamborghini sold for a dollar? I know I haven't and if I did, I would remember. The campaign would arouse curiosity because it's unconventional. What crazy person would sell an expensive car for a buck? Is it a scam? What's the catch? I've got to see!

Another example of unconventional is to break convention by mocking it, or interrupting it. Remember the Energizer bunny? It's still going and going. These commercials built a brand based on unconvention—the advertiser created a series of standard, boring marketing messages and shattered them with sudden